

Concord

A consensus layer for group travel

Helping groups plan trips together, decide together, and adapt together — without turning one person into the permanent trip manager.

\$700B+

ONLINE TRAVEL
MARKET, 2025

67%

OF TRIPS ARE FAMILY
OR FRIEND GROUP
TRIPS

0 → 1

CONCEPT STAGE,
VALIDATION IN
PROGRESS

The 60-second version

The problem Group trips get planned around a shifting patchwork of chats, spreadsheets, and half-finished polls. Existing travel products optimize search and booking — a single-decision-maker problem. They don't help a group of six people with six different budgets actually agree, and fall apart the moment plans need to change.	The insight The hard part isn't reaching a first agreement — it's reopening one. People say yes in the group chat and stay quiet about what's bothering them, because renegotiating costs more social effort than living with a plan that's slightly wrong. The outdated plan wins by default.
The strategy Build the decision layer before the booking layer. Concord privately captures each traveler's constraints, turns disagreement into explainable trade-offs, and reopens only what a change actually affects — with a human always approving the outcome. Trust first; automation and monetization later, deliberately.	Where it stands This is a concept-stage product thesis, grounded in informal customer discovery rather than a completed pilot. The next milestones are structured problem interviews and a human-assisted concierge MVP — both scoped in Section 10.

This case study is written as a strategic exercise for product management interviews — it demonstrates how I structure ambiguous 0 → 1 problems, not a funded or shipped product.

STRATEGIC CONTEXT

Why now, and how big

The current wave of AI travel products treats the traveler as a single decision-maker — great for solo itinerary generation, silent on the fact that most trips aren't solo decisions at all.

- **Group travel is the default, not the exception.** In 2025, 47% of travelers chose a multigenerational or family trip — up 17% year over year — and another 20% traveled with friend groups, together outpacing every other trip type, including solo travel.
- **Coordination still happens off-platform.** The decision itself — who pays what, whose dates work, whose non-negotiables matter — is still negotiated across group chats and phone calls, invisible to any travel product.
- **Agentic AI makes private, constraint-aware negotiation newly feasible.** Earlier tools could only aggregate preferences into a poll. An AI agent can now hold six people's private constraints at once, reason about the trade-offs between them, and explain a compromise in plain language.



Sources: Global Market Insights & Research and Markets online travel market estimates (2025); Squaremouth 2025 Travel Trends Survey. SAM/SOM are directional estimates built for this case study, not third-party research.

PROBLEM & CUSTOMER INSIGHT

What's actually broken

HOW MIGHT WE

Help groups make fair, informed travel decisions efficiently — and renegotiate those decisions when new information, constraints, or opportunities emerge?

Part 1 — Initial agreement

The group must agree on destination, dates, budget, accommodation, transport, activities, and who's responsible for what — while nobody wants to be the one who blocks the trip.

Part 2 — Ongoing alignment

The group must revisit decisions as prices shift, bookings move, availability changes, weather intervenes, or a better opportunity appears — and reopening a decision feels expensive, so most groups don't.

"Groups don't just struggle to agree before a trip. They struggle to renegotiate when circumstances change — and the status quo wins, not because it's best, but because changing it is hard."

RESEARCH NOTE — READ THIS HONESTLY

Discovery so far has been informal: personal travel experience plus conversations with friends and family, not a structured survey or a completed pilot. The patterns below are directional signals worth testing, not validated findings. Section 12 outlines exactly how I'd validate them next.

- People often skip an interesting local find because the existing schedule is too rigid to absorb it.
- A traveler may agree publicly in the group chat while remaining privately dissatisfied.
- Real budgets and constraints are rarely disclosed up front — people reveal them only when pressed.
- Some travelers will pay more for a slightly pricier option simply because it removes uncertainty.
- Trip-critical information is scattered across chats, email, booking confirmations, and individual phones.

TARGET USERS

Who this is for

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Segment	Primary need
Groups of 3–8 friends	A simple way to combine different budgets, preferences, schedules, and activity interests without a single organizer chasing everyone.
Families & multigenerational groups	A fair process that accounts for different generations, comfort levels, mobility needs, and priorities.
The informal trip organiser	Relief from collecting preferences, comparing options, chasing replies, and absorbing every disagreement personally.
Individual travelers	Privacy for sensitive information — personal budget ceilings, time constraints, and non-negotiables — that they wouldn't say out loud to the group.
Travel providers (B2B, later phase)	Clear, pre-negotiated requirements, fewer misunderstandings, and more reliable, timely confirmations.

PRIMARY MVP PERSONA

The **informal organiser** feels this problem most acutely and has the strongest reason to invite everyone else in — making them both the first buyer and the natural distribution loop. Every trip they start pulls 3–7 new people into the product with no separate acquisition spend.

PRODUCT STRATEGY

Positioning & hypothesis

Job to be done

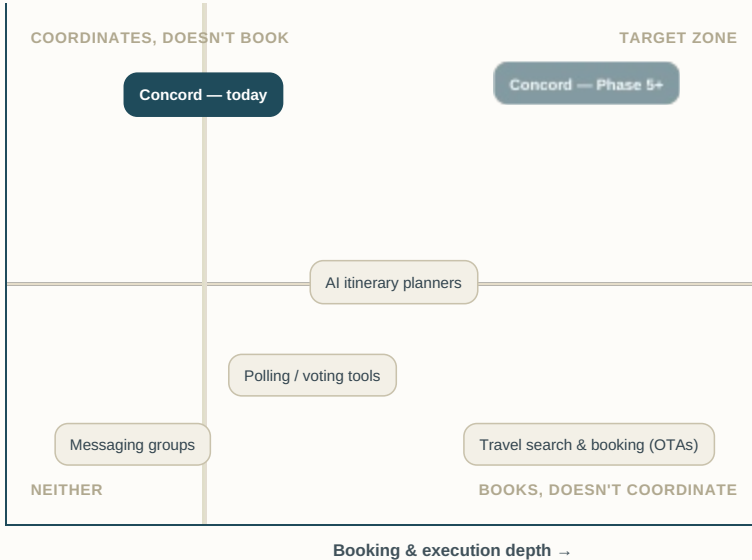
When I'm planning or taking a trip with other people whose preferences or circumstances differ, help us reach a fair, informed decision and keep it workable as conditions change — without making one person the permanent trip manager.

Product hypothesis

If an agent privately captures each traveler's constraints, surfaces the real conflicts, explains trade-offs, and reopens only the decisions a change affects, groups will reach agreement faster, reduce organiser workload, and commit more strongly to the final plan.

Competitive positioning

Vertical axis: group coordination depth (low at bottom → high at top). Horizontal axis: booking & execution depth (low at left → high at right).



Concord enters as a pure decision layer, deliberately weak on booking depth — then earns its way rightward as trust, permissions, and provider integrations mature (see roadmap, Section 10).

PRODUCT PRINCIPLE

The agent decides *how* to reach consensus — not *what* the group should value.

SOLUTION

What the agent actually does

1 Understand

Privately collects preferences, constraints, budgets, schedules, and non-negotiables from each traveler.

2 Identify

Detects conflicts, missing information, and which decisions actually need the group's attention.

3 Facilitate

Presents feasible options, explains trade-offs in plain language, and asks targeted follow-up questions.

4 Coordinate

Manages reminders, deadlines, approvals, and anything left unresolved.

5 Adapt

Detects when a real-world change affects the plan and guides the group through renegotiating only what's actually affected — never the whole itinerary from scratch.

The agent can do	Humans must control
Collect preferences and constraints	Personal values and hard non-negotiables
Keep sensitive information private by default	Whether and how to compromise
Detect conflicts and missing information	Final group decisions
Generate alternatives and explain trade-offs	Consequential bookings and payments
Reopen affected decisions after a change	Whether to accept the new plan

NON-NEGOTIABLES

Never expose a private budget without permission. Never silently override a stated hard constraint. Never choose someone's compromise for them. Never manufacture the appearance of agreement. Consequential bookings and payments always require explicit human approval.

USER JOURNEY

From first invite to a trip that holds together

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- 1

Create the trip

One traveler opens a trip room, adds the basics, and invites the rest of the group.
- 2

Share preferences privately

Each person enters budget, dates, interests, and non-negotiables into their own private space.
- 3

See the real conflicts

The agent identifies where preferences collide and explains, neutrally, why a decision is hard.
- 4

Compare trade-offs, not just options

The agent presents feasible alternatives alongside the cost, time, and comfort trade-offs each one creates.
- 5

Reach and approve agreement

Travelers negotiate directly, then explicitly approve — nothing is booked on their behalf without that approval.
- 6

Adapt when life happens

When something changes mid-trip, the agent flags exactly which commitments are affected and asks only the relevant people to re-approve.

WALKTHROUGH

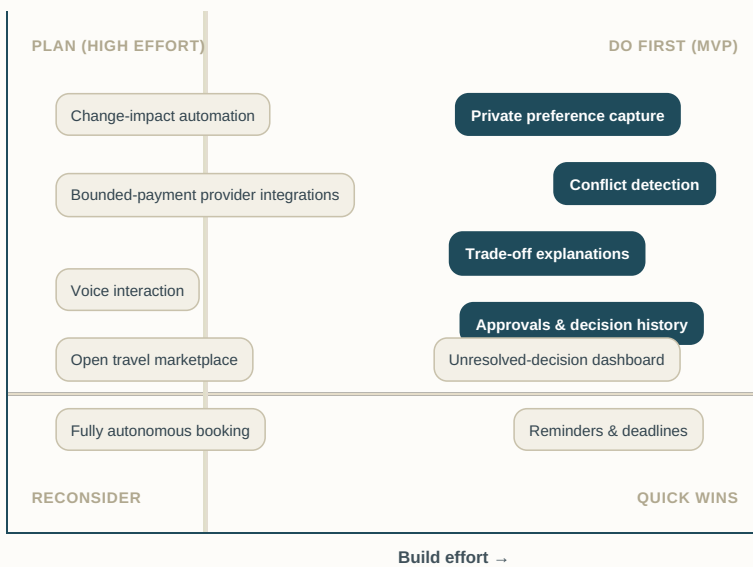
Five friends plan a three-day trip: two want a low-cost stay, one needs an early return on the last day, one wants a popular local experience. Instead of dozens of messages, the agent privately gathers everyone's constraints, finds that the front-runner hotel is cheap but too far from transport, and presents three alternatives with their trade-offs. The group approves one. Mid-trip, a local event conflicts with the schedule — the agent identifies exactly which bookings that touches, proposes revised options, and asks only the affected people to approve. It never changes anything automatically.

PRIORITIZATION

What ships first, and why

07

Sequencing follows one rule: earn the right to touch bookings and money by first proving the agent can be trusted with decisions and information.



Priority	Scope
Must have	Trip room, invitations, private preference capture, shared decision space, conflict detection, feasible options, trade-off explanations, approvals, decision history, change-impact alerts.
Should have	Reminders, deadlines, unresolved-decision dashboard, optional voice input, provider communication, permission controls, audit history.
Could have	Spontaneous opportunity suggestions, photo and memory organisation, post-trip recap, learning from past group trips.
Not in v1	Fully autonomous booking, open-ended spending, automatic compromise selection, a broad travel marketplace.

BUSINESS MODEL

Monetization follows trust, not the other way around

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Phase	Model	Rationale
Prototype & concierge	Free	No monetization. The goal is adoption, trust, and clean signal on where real conflicts occur — charging now would tax the exact behavior (honest disclosure) the product depends on.
Workflow automation	Organiser Pro subscription	Per-trip or monthly plan for frequent organisers: unlimited groups, priority reminders, richer decision analytics. The heaviest user pays, everyone they invite stays free.
Controlled execution	Booking referral commission	A commission only on bookings the group actually confirms through a verified partner — revenue tied to a successful decision, not to steering anyone toward a paying partner.
Expansion	B2B / white-label API	License the consensus engine to tour operators, DMCs, and corporate retreat planners who face the same group-alignment problem at scale.

GUIDING PRINCIPLE

Monetize the outcome — a trip people are excited about — not the argument. Commission-based revenue only arrives once neutrality is established, and recommendations never quietly favor a paying partner over a traveler's stated constraint.

NORTH STAR METRIC

Share of initiated trip decisions that reach full group approval inside the group's own deadline — without the group having to escalate the negotiation back out to a phone call or a side chat.

Category	Metric
Activation	Share of invited travelers who complete private preference capture within 48 hours.
Core value	Time to consensus per decision; organiser workload reduction versus a manual chat-based baseline.
Adaptability	Replanning success rate — the share of disruptions that reach a new approved decision.
Trust & safety	Privacy incidents (target: zero); unauthorized-action rate (target: zero); perceived-fairness score from post-trip surveys.
Business (later phases)	Booking conversion rate through approved partners; Organiser Pro attach rate.

- 1

Discovery

Structured interviews across groups; map current planning workflows and privacy expectations.
- 2

Prototype

Build private preferences, conflict explanations, option comparison, and consensus checkpoints.
- 3

Concierge MVP

Support a small number of real trips with human-assisted coordination behind the scenes.
- 4

Workflow automation

Automate reminders, deadlines, change detection, and replanning suggestions.
- 5

Controlled execution

Add provider communication, verification, and bounded payment permissions.
- 6

Expansion

Property verification, spontaneous-opportunity handling, voice coordination, luggage-gap logistics.

THE GO-TO-MARKET WEDGE

Start exactly where organisers already are — inside a group chat. The first user only has to invite the people they were already going to message, and each invite becomes distribution: no cold acquisition required. Running Phase 3 as a human-assisted concierge also lets the team observe real conflict patterns before automating any of it — the automation in Phase 4 gets built on evidence, not guesses.

Severity	Risk	Mitigation
High	Users don't trust the agent with private information	Make privacy rules visible; give granular, revocable permissions.
High	The agent appears biased toward one traveler	Explain trade-offs neutrally, never rank people's values, always allow overrides.
Medium	The agent misreads a hard constraint	Confirm important requirements explicitly; make corrections fast and easy.
Medium	One person still ends up doing all the work	Give every traveler clear tasks, reminders, and low-effort ways to respond.
Medium	Provider integrations prove unreliable	Begin with verification and human-approved actions before any automation.
Low	The group simply can't agree	Allow an explicit "unresolved" status and make escalation to a human conversation easy, not a dead end.

CLOSING

The thesis, in one page

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Travel groups don't need another itinerary generator. They need help making a decision together, and keeping it workable as life changes around it — without one person carrying the entire coordination burden.

Product	AI group consensus and travel execution agent
Target users	Friends and families planning trips together
Core problem	Group disagreement, hidden constraints, decision fatigue, difficult renegotiation
Primary value	Faster, fairer, more adaptable group travel decisions
Differentiator	Dynamic, ongoing consensus — not a static itinerary
Principle	The agent decides how to reach agreement, never what the group should value
Status	Concept-stage — structured research and prototyping next

What I'd validate first

- Run structured problem interviews with 15–20 recent group travelers to test whether the renegotiation pain is as sharp as the informal discovery suggests.
- Prototype the private-vs-shared preference split with real groups to see whether people actually disclose more when it's private.
- Run a small concierge pilot on 3–5 real trips to learn where the agent's proposed trade-offs diverge from what a thoughtful human organiser would suggest.